

How to use this book

The world of computer science is an exciting one, with hardware and software developing at an amazing pace. As a result, it can be easy to be left behind. This book aims to clearly explain the key concepts in computer science, and the issues arising from using computers.

Who is this book for?

This book can be read separately by parents or young readers, but it's also designed to be read together. The book is aimed at readers at all levels of familiarity with the topic, from people who have little to no understanding of computer science, to those studying it at school or university. The "Getting started" chapter is specifically designed to help readers with no previous computer knowledge to understand basic computer functions, such as how to find files, send emails, or use a web browser. The "Digital behaviours", "Social media", and "Digital issues" chapters focus on the way in which people use computers, and the potential dangers and opportunities they present, and may be of particular interest to parents and teachers worried about things such as social media or cyberbullying.



How the book works

Divided into different sections, this book guides readers through the world of computer science – its origins and history, how hardware and software work, what constitutes good digital behaviour, and what the future might hold. The book defines the concept, and builds on it step by step. Diagrams and illustrations help to flesh out the concepts, and labels and annotations help to point out specific points of interest.

